AEP FROM ZERO • PART 1 • KNOW YOUR CUSTOMER (AEP)

EPISODE 01

What Is Adobe Experience Platform? CDP Explained

What is Adobe Experience Platform, and what does a customer data platform (CDP) actually do? In episode 1 of AEP From Zero you meet Bloom, a wellness brand with 1.2 million customers in three systems that do not talk, and learn the one-sentence definition of a CDP. You will see how Adobe Experience Platform (AEP), Adobe Journey Optimizer (AJO), Customer Journey Analytics (CJA) and the AI layer fit together in Adobe Experience Cloud, and why Real-Time CDP is the commercial name

Free course on iTV • Surge Software Solutions, Bengaluru • Bloom is fictional

Cold open: the Tuesday blast

- 1.2 million customers, three systems
- Same 20% discount to everyone, twice a week
- A 'lapsed' list takes two days in Excel
- Today: what a CDP is, and Adobe's map
- By the end: say it in one sentence

KEY IDEA

Bloom has 1.2 million customers in three systems that never talk, so everyone gets the same 20% discount twice a week.

Three systems that never talk

System	What it holds	What it cannot tell you
E-commerce platform	Orders	Who the buyer really is
CRM export	Names, emails, loyalty points	What they bought last night
Email tool	Who opened what	Whether opens became orders

KEY IDEA

Orders, customer records and email opens live in three tools bought by different teams, and none of them talks to the others.

What not knowing costs Bloom

- 20% off even for people who would buy anyway
- Two days of Excel to pull one lapsed list
- New customers wait up to six days for a welcome
- Thousands of rupees left in carts every night
- Nobody knows which campaigns make money

KEY IDEA

Scattered data costs real money: wasted discounts, two-day list pulls, a six-day welcome wait and carts abandoned every night.

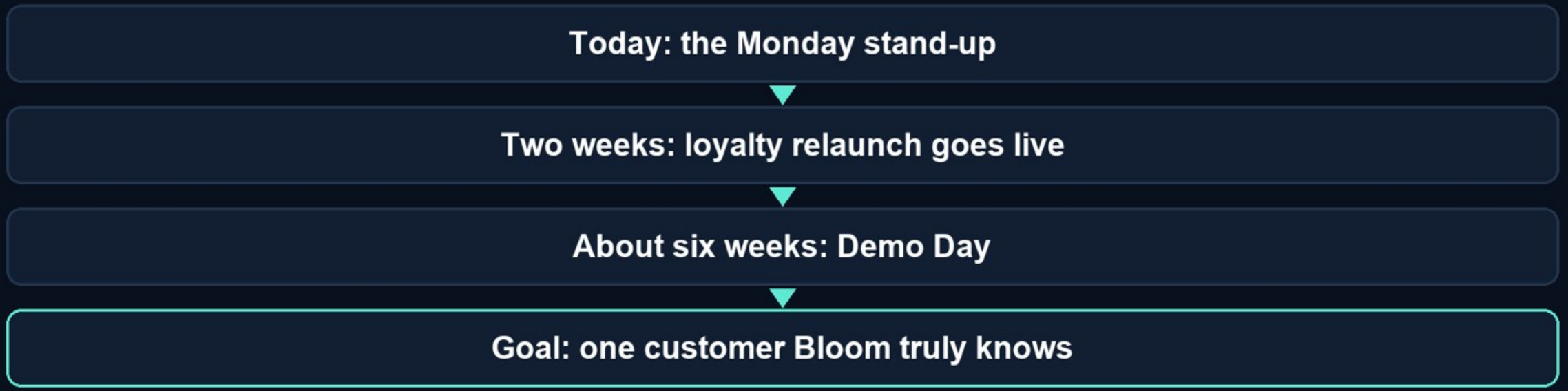
The Monday stand-up: meet the team

- Farhan Qureshi: data engineer, “show me the row”
- Divya Nair: journeys lead, guards the inbox
- Rohan Desai: analyst, “which model, which window?”
- Tara Joseph: legal and privacy counsel
- Vikram Joshi: solution architect and mentor
- Kavya Menon: the newest, and she is you

KEY IDEA

Anjali, the CMO, introduces the new team in sixty seconds, one line each. These are the people you follow all series.

The clock: two weeks to relaunch



KEY IDEA

The loyalty relaunch goes live in two weeks and the board sees results on Demo Day, so the team must show one customer it truly knows.

What is a CDP, in simple words?



KEY IDEA

A Customer Data Platform collects the fragments, joins them into one person, and makes that person usable in real time.

One customer, many keys

Where Priya shows up	What it knows her by
CRM export	Her email, tier and points
E-commerce platform	Orders with her email and BloomID
Bloom app, before sign-in	Only an anonymous app ID
Email tool	Her address and what she opened

KEY IDEA

Each Bloom system knows the same customer by a different key, so joining her into one person is the hard, valuable part.

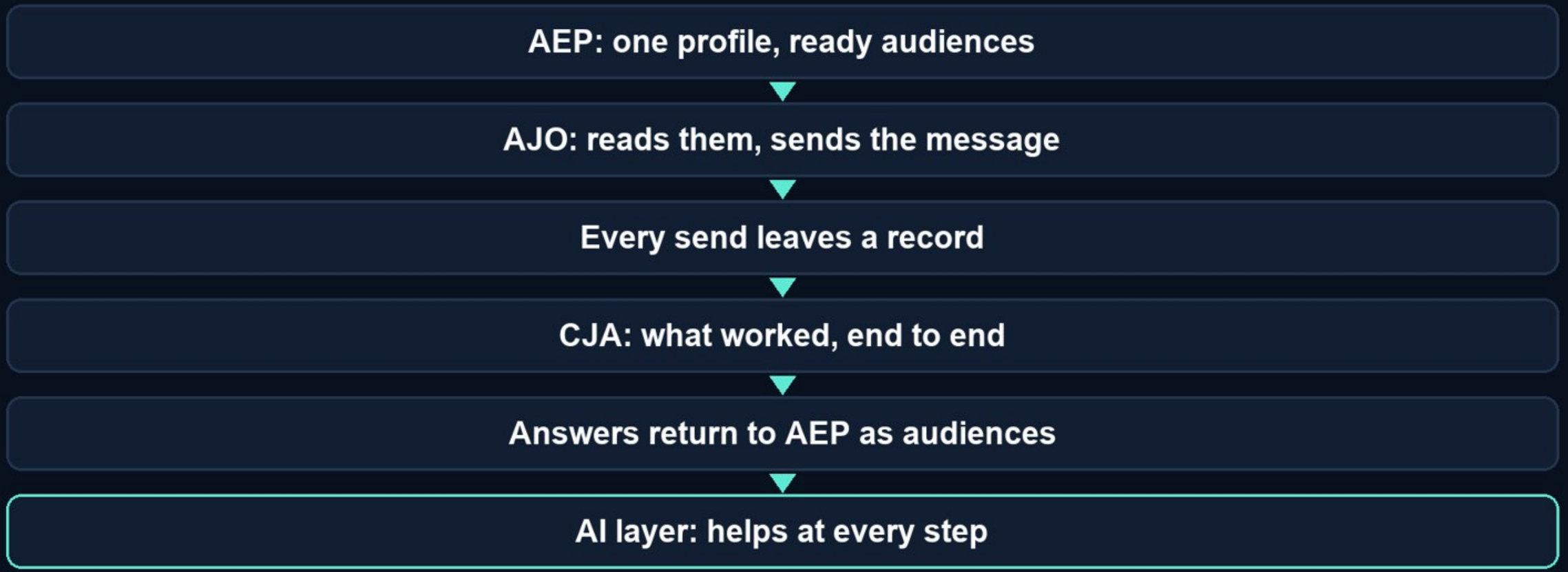
AEP, AJO, CJA and AI: the four-part map

Part	Think of it as	Its job
AEP	The memory	One live profile per person
AJO	The voice	Email, SMS, push, in-app
CJA	The eyes	Looks back: what worked?
AI layer	The colleague	Answers, drafts, does tasks

KEY IDEA

AEP is the memory, AJO the voice, CJA the eyes, and the AI layer the colleague, all standing on one data foundation.

What each part hands to the next



KEY IDEA

Data flows from memory to voice to eyes, the answers flow back as better audiences, and the AI layer helps at every step.

Real-Time CDP vs AEP: same software?

- Real-Time CDP is not a separate product
- It names AEP's profiles, audiences and activation
- Bought Real-Time CDP? You work inside AEP
- Job ad says RT-CDP: profiles, audiences, activation
- Trap: listing them as two different skills

KEY IDEA

Real-Time CDP is not separate software. It is the commercial name for AEP's profile, audience and activation capabilities.

In the product: the App switcher

Sign in to Adobe Experience Cloud

▼

Open the nine-dot App switcher

▼

It sits at the top right

▼

Choose Experience Platform

▼

Look, screenshot, leave

KEY IDEA

As of 2026 you sign in to Adobe Experience Cloud and choose Experience Platform from the nine-dot App switcher at the top right.

Four acts, four gains

Act	Bloom goes from	To
I. Know your customer	Three disconnected databases	One real-time profile
II. Speak to your customer	Twice-a-week batch blasts	Event-driven journeys
III. Prove what worked	Guessing what made money	Every journey seen end to end
IV. Multiply the team	Every task done by hand	AI takes the repetitive work

KEY IDEA

Over about six weeks Bloom moves from scattered data to one profile, to event-driven journeys, to proof of what worked, to an AI-assisted team.

Who leads each act

Act	Lead voice	Owns
I. Know your customer	Farhan, data engineer	Schemas, data, identity
II. Speak to your customer	Divya, journeys lead	Journeys, brand voice, inbox
III. Prove what worked	Rohan, analyst	Customer Journey Analytics
IV. Multiply the team	Vikram, architect	The AI layer, mock interview

KEY IDEA

Farhan leads the data foundation, Divya the journeys, Rohan the analytics and Vikram the AI layer, with Kavya learning in every act.

Interview corner: say it in one sentence

- CDP: collect, join into one person, use in real time
- Real-Time CDP is not separate software
- It names AEP's profile, audience, activation
- Start with the business pain, then the product

KEY IDEA

Two lines for any AEP interview: what a CDP does, and why Real-Time CDP is not separate software.

Recap, your question, and what comes next

- A CDP collects, joins, makes usable in real time
- AEP memory, AJO voice, CJA eyes, AI colleague
- Real-Time CDP: AEP's profile, audience, activation
- Your question: who finds, speaks, proves?
- Next: data lake vs profile store

KEY IDEA

Remember the CDP sentence, the four-part map and the Real-Time CDP truth. Next, Vikram opens AEP itself.